

only twice in 10 essays. It was the appetite for taking on the opposition's premier bowlers that helped him accumulate 16 of his 30 centuries abroad. However, his dominance against pace did not take away his fondness for facing the tweakers.

His run haul against the slower bowlers (3,945) may not match that off pace (5,284), but he fared better against the spinners, as is evident from his average and dismissal rate.

Two of his most prolific years — 2016 and 2017 — were built on his excellence against spin at home, as he tallied back-to-back calendar years with 1,000 runs or more.

In 2018, Kohli scored 1,322, his best yearly haul, effortlessly transitioning his game to embrace overseas assignments. He became just the sixth batter to hold the distinction of scoring 1,000 runs or more in three successive years.

Over the numerous overseas tours, and the varied challenges they brought, Kohli tweaked his front-foot trigger movement and stance (shifting between open and side-on) to counter movement and the lure of the corridor of uncertainty. **Through his successful years, Kohli was more assured playing off his front foot, with nearly 60 per cent (at times more) of his shots from 2014 to 2018 coming from pressing ahead.** In more recent times, the rate has dropped closer to 50. This was evident Down Under recently, where Kohli was confronted by his old nemesis — poking outside the off stump. Very often, he was trapped in the crease due to minimal footwork.

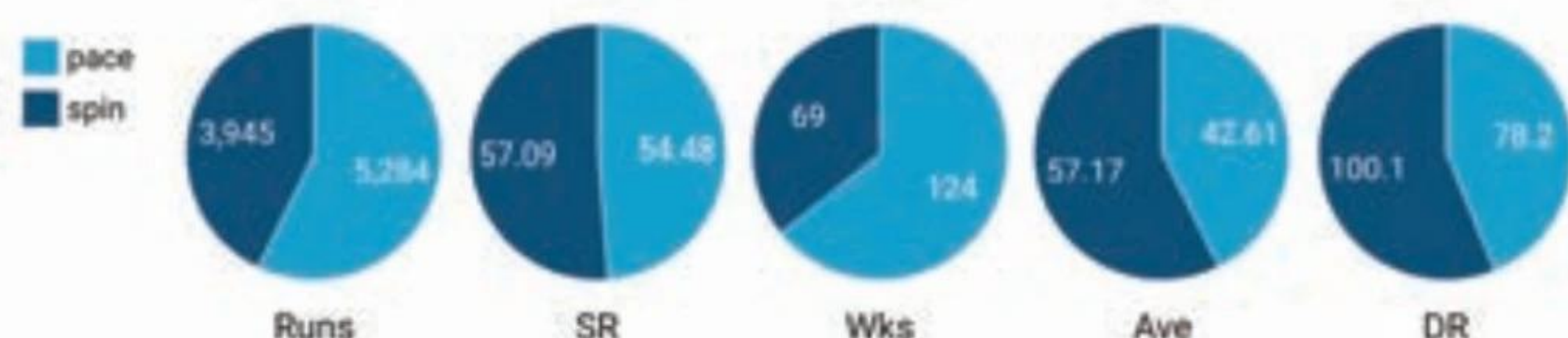
Between 2016 and 2019, Kohli's average against deliveries outside the off stump exceeded 50. Between 2021 and 2024, it dropped below 30 three times, emblematic of his struggle with the line. Kohli faced the prospect of redeeming himself once again in England during the upcoming series, but his decision on May 12 ensured there would be no redemption story.

The Indian talisman walks off into the sunset short of 10,000 Test runs — once his dream — with an average below 50. Even if he falls short of these milestones, his legacy as a modern great remains untarnished, leaving footprints far beyond mere statistics.

Kohli - Against bowling types

Technique	Inns	Runs	RR	SR	Wks	Ave	DR
leg break	42	723	4	66	8	90	138
right pace	182	4,329	3	53	104	42	78
off break	117	1,966	3	57	40	49	86
left orthodox	86	1,148	3	51	19	60	118
left pace	68	955	4	62	20	48	77
left unorthodox	3	108	5	81	2	54	67

Kohli - Spin vs Pace



Kohli against deliveries outside off stump (year-wise)



Fab 4 in Tests since 2021

	Inns	Runs	SR	Wkts	Ave	BpD
KS Williamson	43	2,399	51.83	39	61.51	118.6
SPD Smith	71	3,034	50.23	63	48.15	95.8
JE Root	101	5,149	62.7	91	56.58	90.2
V Kohli	63	1,912	49.43	60	30.86	64.4